|METRIC|
A-A-54003
20 October 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPATULA, DENTAL, CEMENT (No. 313)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification GG-S-590B, style 313, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a spatula of style 313 for use in mixing zinc phosphate cements.

Salient Characteristics:

Material. The spatula shall be fabricated of class 4, type 420 or class 4, type 440A martensitic corrosion-resisting steel, as specified in ASTM 899 for composition only.

Style, design and dimensions. The spatula shall have a single operative end, and shall be of one-piece construction, suitable for mixing cements. The spatula blade shall be properly tapered to provide the necessary flexibility for mixing cements. The spatula handle shall be straight. The spatula handle shall be of octagonal shape, and shall either be smooth or have fillet type serrations. One face of the serrated handle shall be left smooth for identification markings. The style, design and dimensions of the spatula shall conform to Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing 22199.

Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the Rockwell hardness of the operative end (blade) shall be from C40 to C50 inclusive for instruments fabricated from type 420 steel, and from C52 to C56 inclusive for instruments fabricated from type 440A steel. Handles and shanks shall have a minimum Rockwell hardness of C20.

Corrosion resistance. In accordance with ASTM F1089, the spatula shall meet the requirements of the copper sulfate and boil tests when tested as specified herein.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

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Finish. The operative end of each spatula shall have a finish such that when the cement is mixed, it shall not permanently adhere to the spatula. The shank and operative end of each spatula shall have a mirror finish. The smooth spatula handles shall have a bright polished finish.

Identification marking. The spatula shall be permanently and legibly marked as specified herein. All markings shall be on the smooth face of the spatula handle. The word "stainless" shall be marked on instruments of foreign manufacture. As an alternate to the word "stainless," the use of a registered trade name identifying the steel as stainless shall be acceptable, provided prior approval is received from the cognizant contracting officer. Spatulas of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The spatula shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability, proper functioning, or intended use.

Unit. Each (EA). One spatula, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Unit package. Each spatula shall be individually wrapped in suitable anticorrosive material and placed in a properly cushioned bag or box of appropriate size and design. Unit package closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental spilling. Cushioning shall be adequate to prevent damage to the spatula during shipping and handling.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the material, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government.

Quality conformance inspection. The examinations and tests required to assure conformance of those items or lots of items to be offered are classified as specified herein.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an inspection level of II, except the dimensions shall be conducted at inspection level S-1. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one spatula.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The acceptance number shall be zero (0) for all sample sizes. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one spatula. Lots for hardness testing shall be as specified herein.

Tests.

Component	Characteristics	Inspection level
Operative end	Hardness	S-2
Entire instrument	Copper sulfate	S-2
Entire instrument	Boil test	S-2

Sampling of raw materials. A sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the fabrication of the spatulas shall be selected for chemical analysis.

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Examination. The spatula shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. Examination shall be conducted in accordance as specified herein. The spatula shall be examined for defects, including but not limited to, those listed below.

Defects

Style and design not as specified for style 313.
Finish on operative ends not as specified.
Operative ends not free of coarse grind marks or other imperfections.
Operative ends bent.
Dimensions not as specified.
Serrations incomplete or not as specified.
Handles not straight.
Finish on handles and shanks not as specified.
Instrument identification, not present, not legible, not permanent, or improperly located.
Instrument not permanently and legibly marked with the name or registered trademark of the manufacture.
Instruments not free from dirt, oil, polishing compound, or foreign matter.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Hardness. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 (Rockwell) or E92 (Vickers or Diamond Pyramid).

Corrosion test.

Copper sulfate test. The copper sulfate test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Boil test. The boil test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-720-9689	Spatula, Dental, Cement (No. 313)

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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A-A-54003

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

48282

Project No.: 6520-2233
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-54003	SPATULA, DENTAL, CEMENT (No. 313)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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